

MANU'S AUTOGRAPH ON A LEGEND'S CAP



Jonathan Selvaraj & Y. B. Sarangi

jonathan.selvaraj@thehindu.co.in &

sarangi.y@thehindu.co.in

The shooting event in Chateauroux, despite being far away from the main action in Paris, attracts a significant number of spectators. Unlike the venues in Paris, access here is much more relaxed, allowing fans to collect plenty of sports memorabilia. One 'fan' was going around the range, getting medal winners to autograph a white 'Paris 2024' cap.

A closer look, though, made it clear that this wasn't just any fan, but six-time Olympic shotgun medallist and three-time champion Kimberly Rhode of the USA. The most decorated women's shotgun shooter of all time was in Chateauroux, collecting signatures from every Olympic medal winner on her hat, which she plans to auction off to raise money for children's charities in the USA.

As a shooting legend, Rhode finds it fairly easy to get all the signatures she wants. She was particularly pleased to get an autograph from Manu Bhaker. "The goal is to get all the medal winners' autographs, but I'm happy to get Manu's. I saw her shooting yesterday, and I think it's great that she's become the first Indian woman to medal at the Olympics. It's fantastic for Indian shooting. I'm really proud of her, and I hope she does even better," Rhode told *Sportstar*.

People's champion

Rafael Nadal played a significant role at the opening ceremony of the 2024 Paris Olympic Games. As he was handed the Olympic flame by Zinedine Zidane towards the conclusion of the opening ceremony, it was difficult to determine who received the bigger cheer from the audience — the French World Cup hero or the 14-time French Open champion.

After Nadal received the Olympic flame, he joined Serena Williams, Carl Lewis, and Nadia Comaneci on a boat to begin the final stage of transporting the flame to the Tuileries Gardens, where it would be used to light the Olympic Cauldron.

After his part was done, Nadal didn't leave with the other sports stars at the ceremony. Instead, he went back to the Trocadero Gardens where the opening ceremony was happening. When his event was over, Nadal left through the exit gates just like any other

Collecting signatures: Six-time Olympic shotgun medallist and three-time champion Kimberly Rhode of the USA. JONATHAN SELVARAJ